

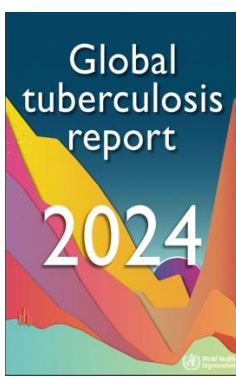
# **Regional and country perspectives: *harnessing synergies and opportunities between TB and PHC***

**Launch of WHO Policy Brief on:  
*TB and Primary Health Care: synergies and opportunities towards Universal Health Coverage***

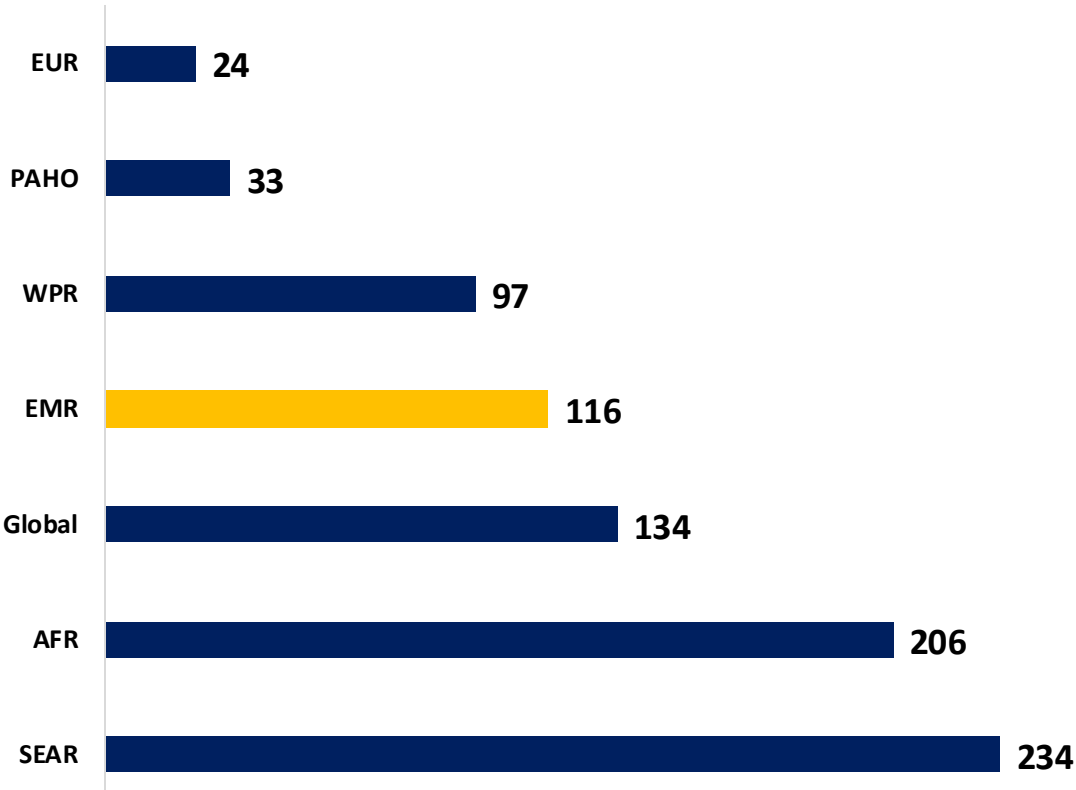
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Eastern Mediterranean Region

# Regional overview

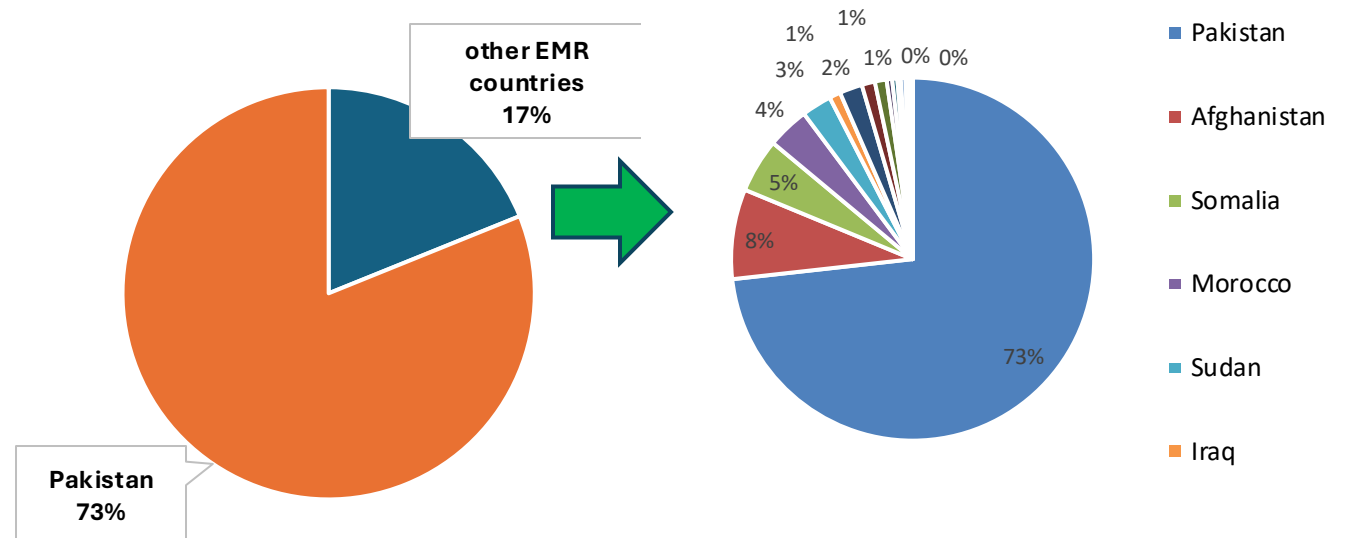
# TB Incidence in EMR, 2023 (10.8 M cases globally)



## EMR TB Incidence (100,000 pop)

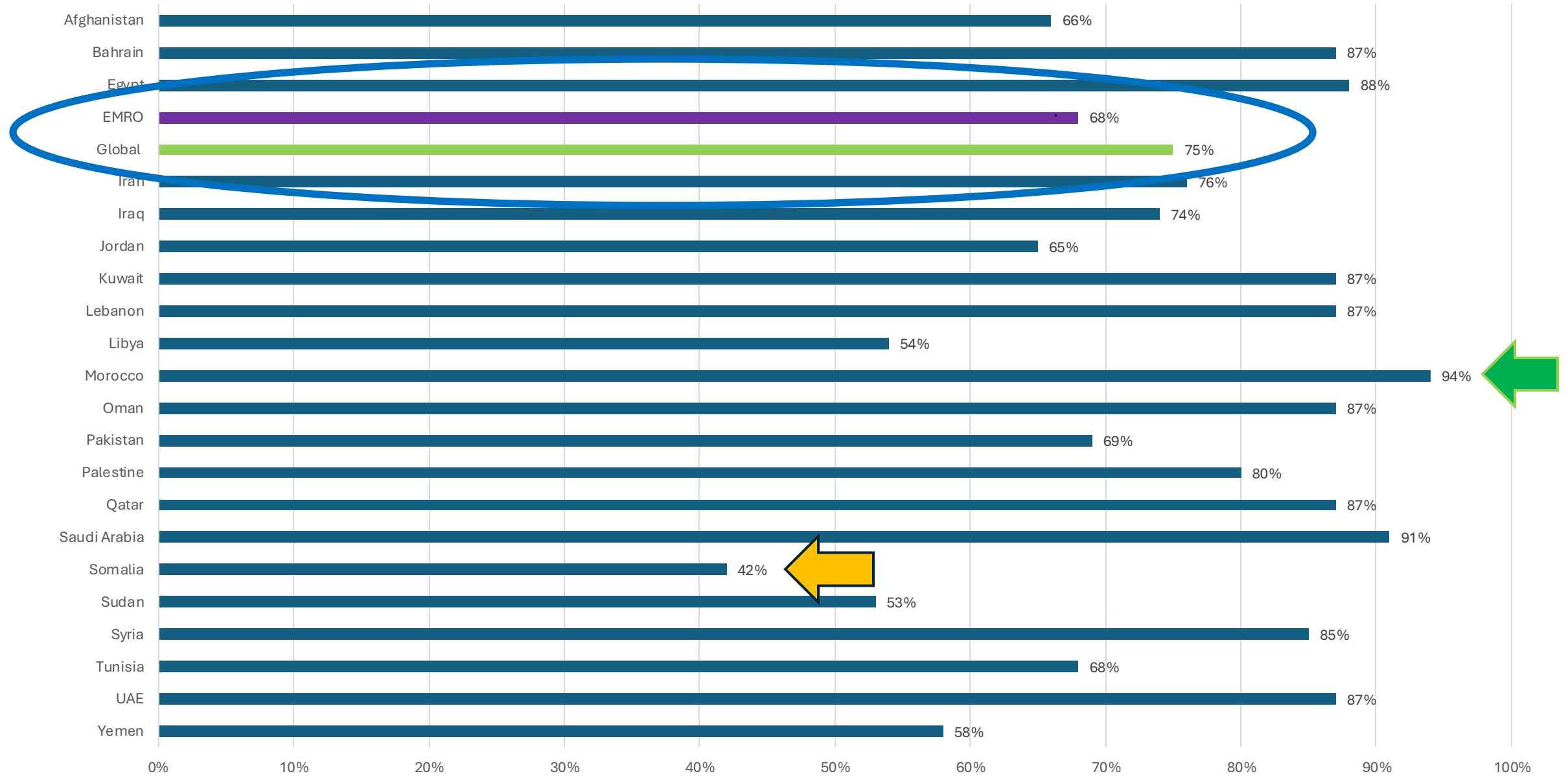


8.1% of global TB incidence in EMR

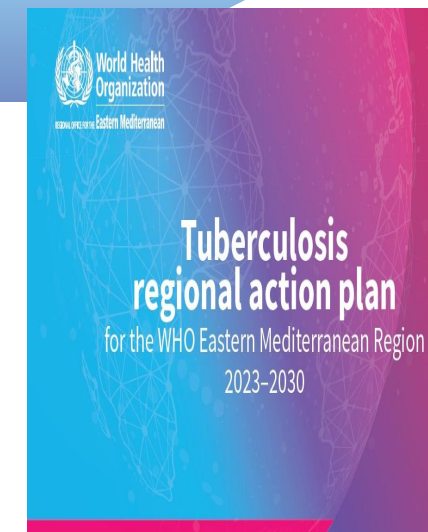
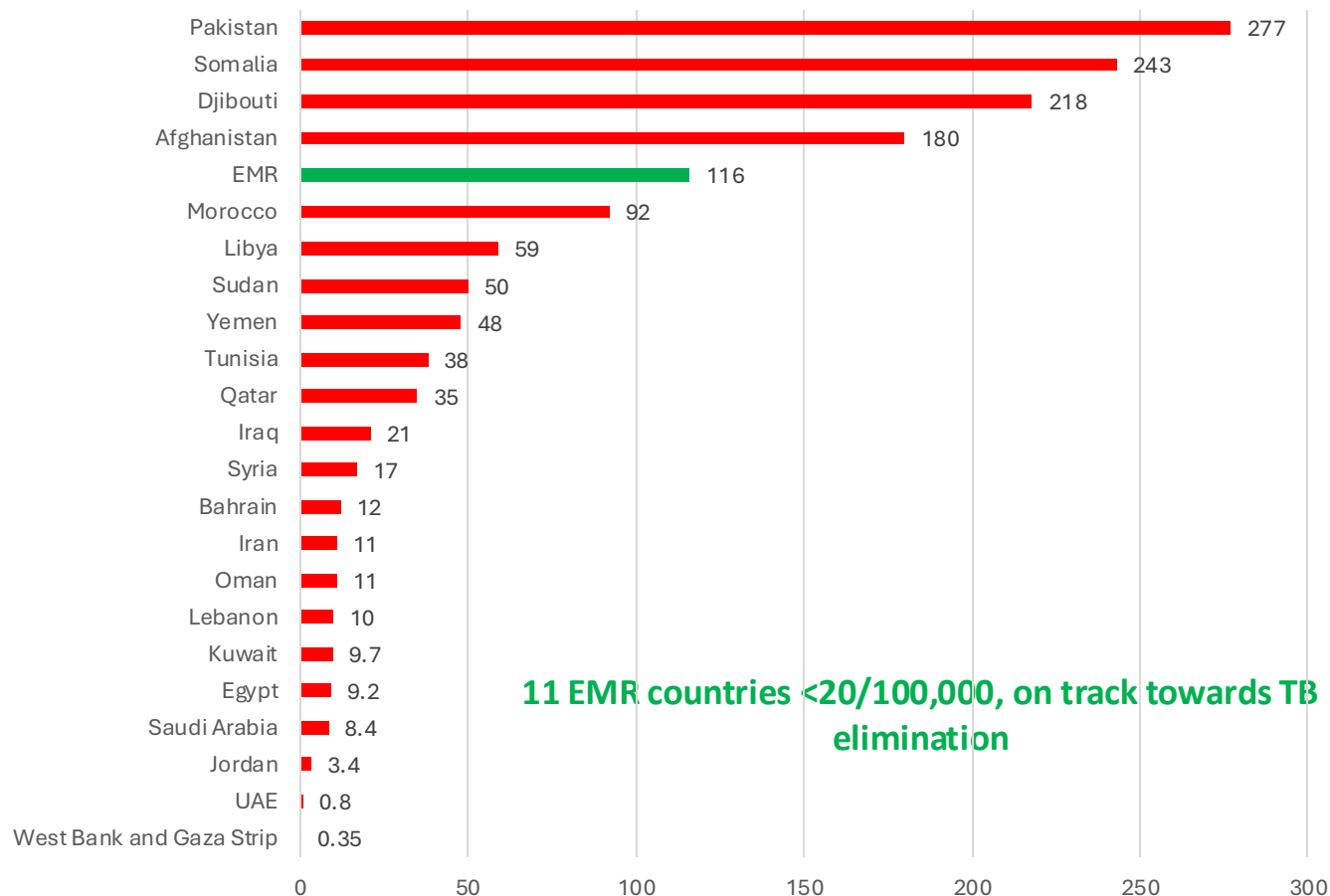


**936,000 TB incidence in EMR, 2023 (One person falling ill every 34 seconds) @ 116/100,000**

## TB treatment coverage – 2023



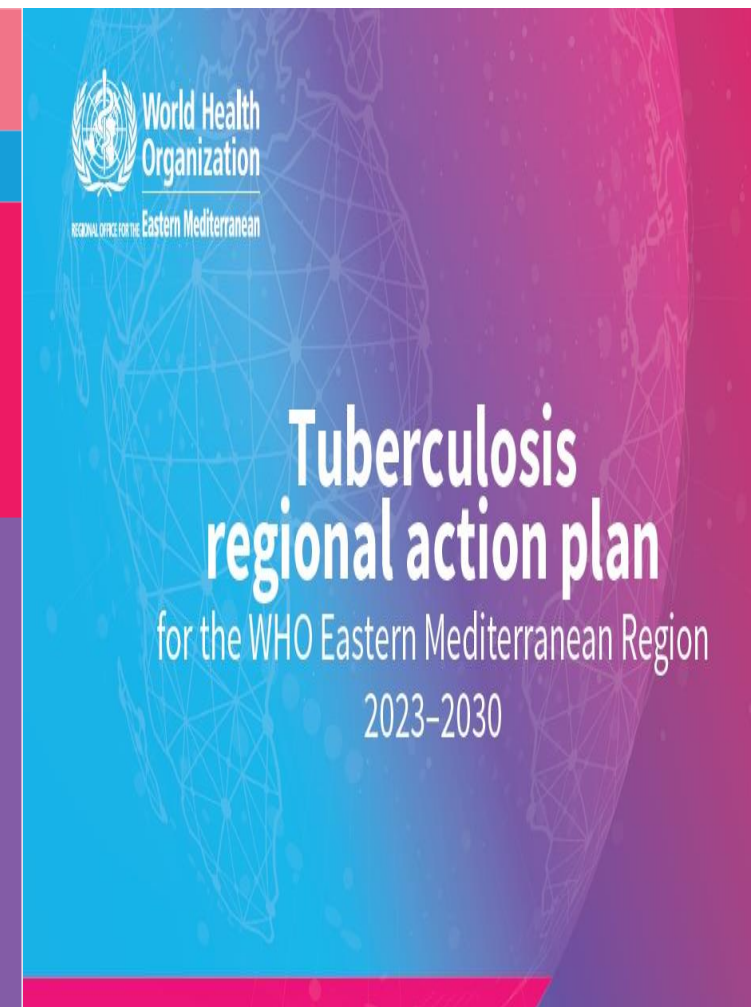
# The EMR approach to end tuberculosis is tailored to countries



| Low-burden countries                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | High-burden countries                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Focus on TB services and active screening in high-risk groups                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Improve access to diagnostics                                                                                 |
| Manage TB and co-morbidities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Improve basic TB data surveillance system                                                                     |
| Manage TB infection with TB preventive treatment                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | General BCG vaccination                                                                                       |
| Case-based, electronic TB information systems, and map TB cases in different population groups                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Support patients and their families through social protection and tackling poverty and social TB determinants |
| Countries affected by complex emergency                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                               |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Implement active screening of eligible individuals belonging to the identified clusters and high-risk groups.</li> <li>Ensure the treatment of TB cases identified.</li> <li>Ensure TB preventive therapy to eligible individuals in line with national guidelines on TB infection management.</li> <li>Monitor implementation of TB infection activities to evaluate outcomes.</li> </ul> |                                                                                                               |

# Goals and objectives 2023-30

|                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Vision</b>       | A WHO Eastern Mediterranean Region with zero deaths, disease and suffering due to TB                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Aim</b>          | End the TB epidemic in the WHO Eastern Mediterranean Region by 2035                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Goal 1.</b>      | Reduce TB deaths by 90% by 2030 compared with 2015                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Goal 2.</b>      | Reduce TB incidence rate by 80% by 2030 compared with 2015                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Goal 3.</b>      | Ensure that 100% of national strategic plans in the Region include actions beyond the health sector, within the health sector and within national TB programmes                                             |
| <b>Objective 1.</b> | Reduce the proportion of missed TB cases from 48% in 2020 to no more than 20% in 2025 and 0% in 2030                                                                                                        |
| <b>Objective 2.</b> | Maintain an average treatment success rate of at least 90% for drug-susceptible TB cases over the period 2023 to 2030                                                                                       |
| <b>Objective 3.</b> | Detect and treat with second-line TB medicines 90% of the estimated number of MDR/RR-TB cases by 2030                                                                                                       |
| <b>Objective 4.</b> | Increase the proportion of notified TB patients who are tested for HIV from 39% in 2020 to 100% in 2030 and increase ARV treatment every year between 2023 and 2030, to 100% of co-infected TB/HIV patients |
| <b>Objective 5.</b> | Increase the number of eligible persons receiving preventive TB treatment to at least 2 million per year by 2030                                                                                            |



# Regional priorities

- Integrate **TB Services into Primary Healthcare** to improve service uptake and sustainability
- Technical support to boost **cross-border TB collaboration, expanding multi-sectoral partnerships**
- Strategic guidance to enhance **TB Treatment coverage** by increasing access to quality diagnosis and treatment
- Scale up **TB Prevention** services by expanding TB preventive treatment, strengthening contact tracing, and improving infection control
- Strengthen **TB surveillance & innovation (e.g. by implementing DHIS 2)**

# Country updates – Pakistan, Afghanistan & Somalia



# Afghanistan – Update on PHC integration

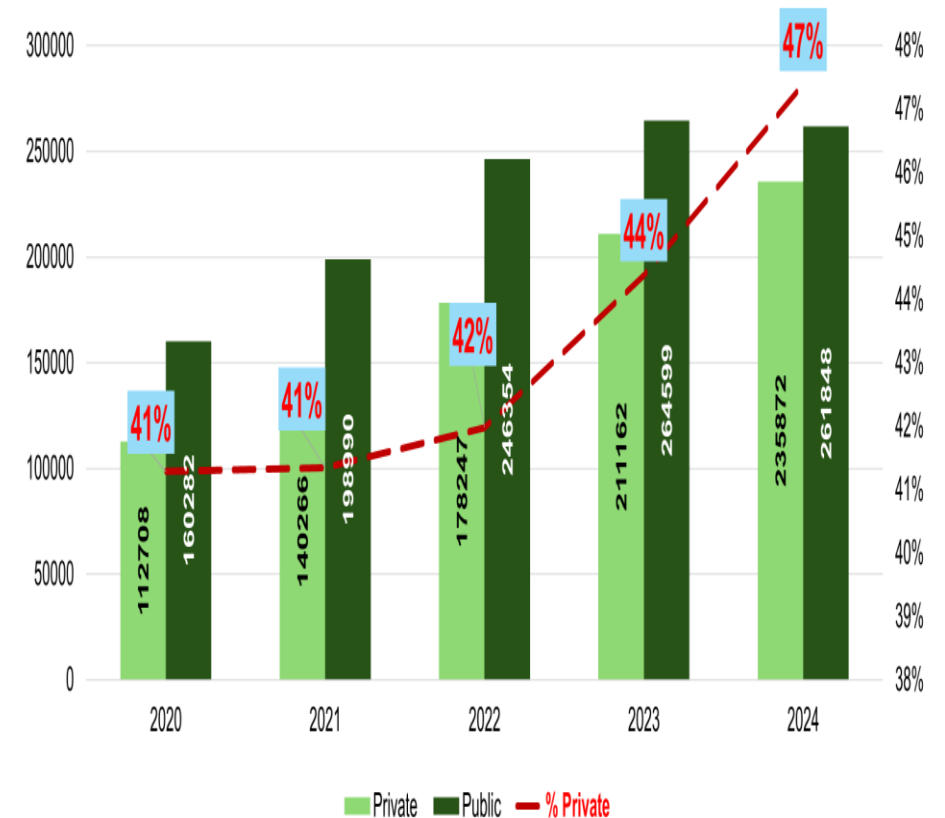
- TB services including diagnosis and treatment have been fully integrated into the Basic Package of Health Services (BPHS) at the primary health care level, and the Essential Package of Hospital Services (EPHS) at the secondary health care level.
- These integrated service delivery models ensure that TB services are accessible to the population through the public health sector. Following integration into BPHS and EPHS, TB services expanded rapidly, improving access and coverage.

| Type of Health Facilities         | IEC on TB | TB presumptive Identification | Microscopic diagnosis | GeneXpert testing | Treatment | Referral for complicated/ DRTB cases | Childhood TB management | Programmatic Management of DR-TB | TB/HIV collaborative activity* |
|-----------------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|-----------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| National hospital                 | ✓         | ✓                             | ✓                     | ✓                 | ✓         | ✓                                    | ✓                       | ✓                                | ✓                              |
| Regional hospital (RH)            | ✓         | ✓                             | ✓                     | ✓                 | ✓         | ✓                                    | ✓                       | ✓                                | ✓                              |
| Provincial hospital (PH)          | ✓         | ✓                             | ✓                     | ✓                 | ✓         | ✓                                    | ✓                       | ✓                                | ✓                              |
| District hospital (DH)            | ✓         | ✓                             | ✓                     | ✓                 | ✓         | ✓                                    | ✓                       | ✓                                | ✓                              |
| Comprehensive Health Center (CHC) | ✓         | ✓                             | ✓                     |                   | ✓         | ✓                                    |                         |                                  |                                |
| Basic Health Center (BHC)         | ✓         | ✓                             |                       |                   | ✓         |                                      |                         |                                  |                                |
| Sub- health center                | ✓         | ✓                             |                       |                   | ✓         |                                      |                         |                                  |                                |
| Mobile Health Team                | ✓         | ✓                             |                       |                   |           |                                      |                         |                                  |                                |
| Health post                       | ✓         | ✓                             |                       |                   | ✓         |                                      |                         |                                  |                                |

# Pakistan – update on PHC integration

- WHO PRIME TB initiative for strengthening strategic TB planning
- A collaborative blueprint to improve governance, leadership, and partnership to end tuberculosis in Pakistan (endorsed 2021)
- Development of costed NSP and PSPs (2024-2026). Strategic objectives/interventions include engagement of PHC facilities
- Data use and analysis using WHO case based DHIS 2 tracker
- Intensified engagement of private sector and communities: PPM models in 120 districts (accounts for 47% of national notification) & sustained LHWs intervention in 43 districts
- Piloting experiences strongly support integrated PHC approach and reflect the high impact low cost missed opportunities in the system.
  - WHO health system support for integrated Model of Care (PHC) in two districts (Charsadda & Islamabad)
  - WHO support for MAF TB & PHC in two districts of Punjab (Hafizabad & Gujrat)
  - WHO support for TB & mental health (Hafizabad, Punjab Province), TB and RMNCH (Charsadda, KP Province) collaboration pilots

## TB Notifications: Public v/s Private Sector National Trend



# Pakistan – Update on PHC integration (2)

## Opportunities

- Multisectoral engagement = catalytic enabler
- Collaboration with ILO on social protection for TB patients
- Through its National Health Vision 2016 – 2025, Pakistan has included UHC in its national agenda; TB included in “Essential Universal Health Coverage Package”
- Lady health care workers (LHWs)’ network, bringing TB services closer to patients and improving PHC and community involvement
- Integrating TB service delivery capacity into overall health workforce development

## Challenges

- Donor dependence
- Sustainability of TB services. Funding situation expected to worsen further from 2027 onwards
- Fragmented data information systems over-burdening the HCWs
- Lack of integrated multi-diagnostic platforms

# Somalia – Update on PHC integration

- The Essential Package of Health Services (EPHS) is Somalia’s platform for delivery of primary health care services
- It is delivered through 4 tiers of facilities (Hospital, Referral Health Centre, Health Centre, and Primary Health Units) complemented by community health service delivery
- Currently over 50 TB centers, out of 122, are fully integrated into PHC

| Level of Care                                     | Services                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Remarks                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Community</b>                                  | Provide community-based TB education<br>Perform active case finding for TB                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | This is being done by community health workers supported by GF                                                                                                            |
| <b>Primary Health Unit</b>                        | Provide community-based TB education<br>Perform contact tracing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | This is being done by community health workers supported by GF                                                                                                            |
| <b>Health Centre</b>                              | Screen for TB in high-risk groups, including children and PLHIV<br>Provide TB preventive therapy according to current WHO guidelines<br>Perform sputum AFB testing<br>Prescribe first-line treatment for drug- susceptible TB per current WHO guidelines<br>Refer treatment failures for assessment of drug-resistant TB<br>Arrange for DOTS including administration by responsible caregivers | Most TB centers are located in the health centers.<br>Some of these TB centers have Gene Xpert machines for TB diagnosis<br>Few of them are still using sputum microscopy |
| <b>Referral Health Centre (District Hospital)</b> | Provide molecular diagnostics or culture for diagnosis of drug-susceptible and drug-resistant TB<br>Advanced management of TB treatment failures                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | TB centers with Gene Xpert machines.<br>8 MDR-TB treatment satellite centers are located at this level                                                                    |
| <b>National / Regional Hospital</b>               | Manage MDR-TB and XDR-TB as per WHO guidelines<br>Perform surgical intervention for TB                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | The 3 MDR-TB treatment centers are still stand-alone centers not fully integrated into the National/Regional Hospitals                                                    |

# Key takeaways

- Embedding TB at policy level is a must for sustained TB in PHC integration
- Heterogenic TB landscape requires individual adaptation of policy guidance
- Improvements are not imminent, but some country examples demonstrated increasing case finding and improved TB treatment outcomes through TB and PHC integration

# Thank you!

## Acknowledgements

- WHO colleagues, particularly Drs N. Wilson, S. Kelamane, I. Sindani and L. Khawaja
- EMR NTP managers of Afghanistan, Pakistan and Somalia